

Research Agenda

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CEFAU Start-up Retreat

September 5, 2025

Research Topics Overview

Core Research Focus

Matching markets with and without search frictions at the intersection of labor, family, and macroeconomics.

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- Combine **micro data** with insights from **economic theory** to understand matching between heterogeneous agents:
 - Two-sided heterogeneity: workers and firms, men and women
 - Sorting (who marries whom, and why?)

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 - Sorting (who marries whom, and why?)
- Analyze effects of sorting on **labor market dynamics** and **wage inequality**
- Examine how marital sorting interacts with **policy** (UI, tax, parental leave, management quotas) and affects **inequality**

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Three Main Research Areas

① **Sorting and Labor Market Dynamics**

- Reallocation of workers to firms over business cycles
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- **Marriage market:** Development of new categorizations and measurement strategies

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③ **Joint Household Decisions**

- Integration of marriage market and labor market equilibrium
- Marriage & divorce, joint labor supply and job search, **the role of firms**

Methods, Theories, and Data

Theoretical Frameworks

- **Search-matching models** (Shimer & Smith, 2000)
- **Frictionless matching models** (Choo & Siow, 2006)
- **Two-way fixed effects** methodology (Abowd et al., 1999)
- **Production function estimation** (Akerberg et al., 2015)

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Key Methodologies

- **Reduced-form identification strategies** to produce facts
- **Structural estimation** of dynamic equilibrium models
- **Counterfactual policy analysis** ...what if?

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Primary Datasets

- **German/Danish/US** register and household/firm survey data

Research Questions: Families and Firms

The Role of Firms for Gender Inequality

- How does joint search and joint labor supply of households interact with firm policies? Wages? Amenities? Training? Promotion?
- Existing work in family economics largely ignores firms.
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- Ciscato et al. (2025): Exogenous variation in who marries whom.

Insights and Analytics

Keep the families in mind...

- Everything depends on who marries whom!
- Marriage Markets tend to dampen the effects of policies aimed at reducing inequality across households and gender through rematching
- Labor market reforms and firm policies aimed at reducing gender inequality affect marriage formation and marital stability

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Of interest for firms and CEFAU because...

- Which workers should firms train and promote? Retention motives.
- Firms' response to parental leave? Substitute workers? Output?
- What do firms know about who the partner of a given worker is, if any? How to take it into account? Legal rules vs. micro and macro.